

Wednesday, August 10

Now that Matthew is up early each day Cheryl and I get a quick start. All the preliminaries, washing, eating, cleaning up, are finished by 9. Peter had a good cello practise. He is putting all four fingers on one string as he plays. He does this with all his songs.

Cheryl worked up a sweat this morning to get the house ready for the arrival of Danny and Joan from Duncan. Peter and I cleaned space for my study in the basement. We bought some screws for shelving and took all my books from their boxes. When we got back from Canadian Tire Peter watched Mr. Dressup and Sesame Street.

I went to Roland Michener School at 11:15 to get Problem Solving material for a writing project and a Science curriculum guide for Cheryl. She is trying to make up her mind about subject areas for this fall. Cheryl made a fruit salad and toast for dinner. I took Peter to his 'Pedal Pusher' class. He didn't like the hot sun. He flushes bright red when he's outdoors for any time. He went to the University with the others. His back carried bits of mud.

We went downtown after the Field House. Cheryl has money from Christmas to buy a winter coat. They went on sale today. She prefers a certain close-cut navy coat with a wrapping scarf and belt from Eaton's. We put it on hold. We looked for snowsuits. Peter is almost out of his. I bumped into Kathy Haugrud and her two children seconds before Colleen Muth called to me. I didn't get a chance to see either of them. Peter was wearing his red duckbill baseball cap. Cheryl took it off while trying on coats. His damp hair was curling. Peter tried to get it down. He couldn't do it so he put the cap on again.

The boys slept when we got home. Supper was corn on the cob and hamburgers. Peter was too tired to eat more than one cob. Matthew didn't eat well either. His teeth have been bothering him.

After cleaning up we joined the Skarsgards at a new restaurant named "Lydia's", just above "Onion Books" on 11th and Broadway. Only the Great Grandparents were there with Cheryl's parents. The atmosphere is relaxed. Music is soft. We ate German chocolate cake, cheesecake, ice-cream and drank

coffee, orange juice and iced tea. The children were held all around. Harvey and Anne were expected. Some photos of the farm were passed around. Large windows offered the view of the dark street where children ran and couples sat outside their houses.

We were home by 9:30. Cheryl's parents came downstairs. The study is nearly finished; most books are shelved, maps and prints are tacked to the wall. Cheryl's dad helped me shift two large rugs into place. We discussed the upcoming trip to Vancouver and down the coast. Peter looked through a catalogue, his eye on guns for Santa to bring. Matthew walked across the room several times. He applauded each arrival. Matthew looked for Peter and found him in his bedroom on his back listening to tapes. They don't often play with the same toy, but today Peter sat against the chest and Matthew right beside him leaning over a game.

Frequently we hear Peter say, "Good boy Matthew. Mom, Dad, Matthew is walking."

Matthew flatters Peter too. He pays close attention to everything he does, eyes making subtle adjustments to follow each move as Peter works at something. After a few moments of this Matthew will look up and laugh until Peter says something more to him.

Later Peter said, "I've been twice times over the bridge to the Universtity (sic)."

I asked, "What do things look like from there?"

"Small. It would be dangerous to jump on the cars, wouldn't it."

"Perhaps. Maybe not so bad if you went through a sunroof or landed in a convertible."

"But we couldn't do that with our car, right? Our car roof is very fragile."

Cheryl just received a phone call. Danny and Joan have had enough of the heat, mosquitoes and blackflies. They have not been sleeping. They will drive straight home from up north.